MODULE-3 · MASTERCLASS DOSSIER

3.4 Radio Ready Audio

Lesson masterclass · implementation drills · war-room directive

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Prepare radio-ready, clean-edited audio for daytime clocks.
- Produce the 30-second forwarding asset programmers pass along.
- Package and name files so the programmer does less work.

★ **INSIDER RADIO TIP**

The 30-second cut is the forwarding asset — the one PDs pass to their promo team. Always include the smallest, hook-loaded 30-sec version in every package.

▲ **THE OPERATOR MOVE**

Name the 30-sec file ‘ARTIST_TITLE_30sec.mp3’ and put it first in the download folder. One less step for the PD is one more step for your add.

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3.4 Radio-Ready Audio — The 90-Second Weapon That Forces Replies

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THE ONE-LINE TRUTH: A programmer does not have time to sit through a five-minute album cut. The 90-second audio weapon and compliant broadcast master remove every technical barrier between your music and their transmitter.

MASTERCLASS DIRECTIVE & STRATEGIC BLUEPRINT

Strategic Foundation & Operational Reality

Nothing destroys an artist’s credibility faster than delivering technically non-compliant audio files. When a programmer agrees to air your track, they expect to drag the file directly into their station automation software (such as WideOrbit, RCS Master Control, ENCO, or Dalet) and have it play flawlessly on the station’s broadcast chain.

If your file is an uncensored master with explicit language, an unmastered quiet bounce at −24 LUFS, an over-compressed file clipping past 0.0 dBFS, or an amateur MP3 titled `song_final_v3.mp3` with missing ID3 metadata, the station engineer or DJ will delete it rather than spend 15 minutes fixing your packaging.

Dominion operators understand the technical physics of broadcast processing and deliver a complete, turn-key **Radio-Ready Audio Package**.

Broadcast Audio Specifications & Standards

To ensure seamless integration across FM transmitters, digital HD sidebands, and web streams, your master deliverables must strictly adhere to industry standards:

1. **Loudness Standards (LUFS):** While streaming platforms normalize to −14 LUFS, FM radio broadcast chains utilize aggressive multi-band hardware limiters (such as Orban Optimod or Omnia processors). Deliver an integrated loudness of **−12 to −14 LUFS** with a maximum True Peak of **−1.0 dBTP** to prevent inter-sample clipping when passed through broadcast transmission encoders.
2. **Dedicated FCC Clean Radio Edit:** An absolute requirement for daytime terrestrial broadcast. Every profane or suggestive lyric must be cleanly reversed, muted, or re-recorded with alternate phrasing. Never assume a college or community station can air explicit language during daytime hours; the FCC levies severe fines for broadcast obscenity between 6:00 AM and 10:00 PM.
3. **The 90-Second Audio Weapon:** In addition to the full radio edit, create a dedicated 90-second promotional sampler that cuts directly from an abbreviated 5-second intro into Verse 1, leaps straight to the chorus hook, showcases the dynamic bridge peak, and concludes with a crisp button outro. This is the file you link in your pitch when targeting busy programmers.
4. **The 30-Second Sweeper Hook:** A 30-second high-energy hook segment bookended by silence, designed specifically for station imaging producers to build promotional sweepers and upcoming concert teasers.

IMPLEMENTATION DRILLS & PASS STANDARDS

- **Drill 1 — Broadcast Master Specification Audit (25 min).** Open your primary single in your digital audio workstation (DAW) or mastering meter. Measure Integrated LUFS, Short-Term Max, and True Peak. Verify True Peak does not exceed −1.0 dBTP.
- **Drill 2 — The FCC Clean Edit Protocol (30 min).** If your track contains explicit lyrics, bounce a dedicated FCC Clean Radio Edit. Ensure vocal cuts or reversals sound musical and seamless.
- **Drill 3 — The 90-Second Weapon Cut (30 min).** Edit a dedicated 90-second audio weapon file: 0:00–0:05 intro, 0:05–0:30 verse, 0:30–1:00 chorus, 1:00–1:30 bridge + final hook.
- **Drill 4 — Standardized ID3 Metadata Stamping (20 min).** Tag all audio deliverables with comprehensive broadcast metadata using the Standardized Naming Convention below.

ACTION WORKSHEET & OPERATIONAL PROTOCOL

Protocol Document: `BROADCAST AUDIO SPECIFICATION & DELIVERABLE MATRIX`

Complete the structured table below as part of your lesson implementation. This worksheet directly replaces legacy spreadsheets with a publication-grade execution protocol.

Deliverable Asset	Technical Format	Loudness & Peak Target	Standardized File Naming Convention	Operational Deployment
Broadcast Master (Full)	24-bit / 44.1kHz WAV	−12 to −14 LUFS / −1.0 dBTP	ArtistName_TrackTitle_RadioEdit_Clean.wav	Direct automation playout file
FCC Clean Radio Edit	24-bit / 44.1kHz WAV	−12 to −14 LUFS / −1.0 dBTP	ArtistName_TrackTitle_FCC_Clean.wav	Daytime terrestrial rotation safe
90-Second Audio Weapon	320kbps MP3 (Clean)	−12 LUFS / −1.0 dBTP	ArtistName_TrackTitle_90Sec_Weapon.mp3	Direct streaming link in 90-word pitch
30-Second Sweeper Hook	24-bit / 44.1kHz WAV	−12 LUFS / −1.0 dBTP	ArtistName_TrackTitle_30s_Hook.wav	Station imaging & on-air concert promo
Instrumental Broadcast Bed	24-bit / 44.1kHz WAV	−14 LUFS / −1.0 dBTP	ArtistName_TrackTitle_Instrumental.wav	DJ talkover bed during voice breaks

WAR-ROOM NOTES

WAR-ROOM DIRECTIVE — 3.4 Radio-Ready Audio — The 90-Second Weapon That Forces Replies

THE ID3 METADATA DISASTER THAT COST 10,000 SPINS

When station automation software ingests an audio file, it reads the internal ID3 metadata tags (Artist, Title, Album, Year, ISRC, Composer, Record Label) to automatically generate on-air RDS dashboard displays (the text showing on car dashboards) and report spins to ASCAP/BMI and SoundExchange.

If your audio file has blank ID3 tags, the automation system logs the spin as `Unknown Artist — Track 01`.

- You receive zero public royalties.
- Car dashboards display zero artist information to listeners.
- The DJ cannot announce your name because the computer screen shows a blank field.

MANDATORY METADATA EMBEDDING:

Use a dedicated metadata editor (such as MP3Tag or Kid3) to permanently write:

- Track Title (include `(Clean Radio Edit)`)
- Artist Name
- Album Name & Release Year
- Composer / Songwriter Full Legal Names
- ISRC Code (International Standard Recording Code)
- Publisher & PRO Affiliation (e.g., `BMI / Work ID #`)

FREQUENCY DOMINION COMMUNITY DRILLS

1. Post a screenshot of your audio metering tool showing integrated LUFS and True Peak on your master bounce.
2. Confirm that your audio file names conform 100% to the Standardized File Naming Convention.
3. Share your 90-Second Audio Weapon link with the community for pacing and hook impact feedback.
4. Verify that your ISRC codes and PRO publisher details are embedded in your master metadata.

Key Takeaways

REMEMBER THIS

- Logistics dominate programming decisions.
- The 30-second cut is the forwarding asset.
- Name and order files for the programmer.

Self-Assessment · Check Your Mastery

PASS BEFORE YOU MOVE ON

- 1. Is my audio radio-ready and clean-edited?
- 2. Do I have a hook-loaded 30-second forwarding cut?
- 3. Are my files named and ordered for the programmer?